THE WITNESS REMAINS-The Exile of Two Generations

A Prophetic Indictment of Family Abandonment, Community Power, Homophobic Shame, Financial Exploitation, Administrative Erasure, and the Denial of Protection

By Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

My testimony. My life. The documentary record. The unanswered questions.

This is not a court. It is not a verdict. It is a demand that the record be examined, the questions answered, and the human being behind the documents no longer be erased.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

THE WITNESS REMAINS

A Prophetic Indictment of Family Abandonment, Community Power, Homophobic Shame, Financial Questions, and Administrative Erasure

Author: Dr Richard William McLean
Project: Barran Dodger — Documentary Preservation and Accountability

Purpose

This statement brings together my personal testimony and my demand for a fair, evidence-based examination of events that I believe have shaped my life: family exclusion, homophobic humiliation, relationship conflict, concerns about Nana's isolation and care, unresolved inheritance questions, questions about carer-related payments, and prolonged difficulties obtaining satisfactory answers from public institutions.

I have preserved a substantial documentary archive because I do not want these matters reduced to competing recollections or dismissed without examination. I ask readers to distinguish what I directly experienced, what surviving records establish, and what remains my interpretation or a question requiring further evidence.

The central issues

1. Community standing and private exclusion. My father was involved in a local, all-male baseball club and, as I understood it, had extensive community connections. I never played baseball and experienced exclusion from that part of his life from an early age. I

believe the contrast between his community belonging and my own isolation is important. Community reputation alone cannot establish what occurred within a family or determine whose account deserves to be heard.

2. Homophobic humiliation and the police-station incident. I have described a troubling incident involving a girl and a local police station, which I came to believe was contrived or used to shame me about my sexuality. I also experienced intensified shaming after coming out as gay. I want any relevant police records, statements, communications, and contemporaneous evidence examined. My concerns about who knew what and whether prejudice influenced subsequent treatment require evidence-based investigation.

3. My former fiancé, Steve Iasonidis. I experienced the relationship as exploitative and believe members of my family supported him while failing to protect me from treatment I found harmful. I want relevant communications and events examined chronologically, without substituting assumptions about anyone's motives for evidence of actual conduct.

4. Nana, inheritance, and family exclusion. Nana was deeply loved by me, and I felt she supported me. I became concerned that she had been isolated from important relationships and deprived of agency or adequate care. I have questioned whether elder abuse or neglect occurred. After her death, I say my parents took $1,000 from me in connection with an inheritance. I want her care and estate records, any will, relevant correspondence, and the circumstances of that payment examined. I also experienced exclusion when other family members went on an approximately eight-week European holiday without me. These events form part of my account of family rupture, although the holiday alone does not prove wrongdoing.

5. Carer-related payments and financial vulnerability. I have raised questions about payments my parents allegedly received after I left their accommodation, and about a later carer-payment application involving Steve Iasonidis. I have also reported what Steve told me about information he said he obtained concerning those payments. The precise payment types, eligibility rules, dates, applications, and official decisions must be established from records. I do not present the alleged source of that information or the legality of any claim as independently verified.

6. Administrative accountability. I have documented interactions with Australian public agencies involving information requests, complaint handling, employment-status questions, and other administrative decisions. I seek examination of the original documents, reasons, timelines, review pathways, and practical consequences. An adverse decision does not automatically prove misconduct, but institutional authority should not exempt a decision from scrutiny.

The documentary record

The Barran Dodger project preserves and organises documents intended to assist readers in examining these matters. Key starting points include:

- **Main repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger**
- **Official Government Documents Register: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/official-government-documents-register.html**
- **PDF archive: https://github.com/wezzo72/pdf-archive**
- **Rebuilt public archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/**
- **Victim Impact Statement: https://www.barrandodger.com.au/post/victim-impact-statement**

These are entry points to documentary material, not proof that every interpretation or allegation is established. Each relevant record should be assessed for authenticity, context, chronology, and what it actually demonstrates.

What I am asking for

I seek a fair examination of the evidence; clarification of unresolved family, financial, and administrative questions; preservation of relevant records; and meaningful accountability wherever the evidence establishes wrongdoing. I also ask that my testimony not be automatically dismissed because of my psychiatric history, personal vulnerability, or sexuality.

My experiences of threatening and degrading voices have caused significant distress. I cannot establish their source from the words alone, and I do not claim that they independently prove involvement by any particular person or organisation. My safety and wellbeing matter regardless of their cause.

Conclusion

My position is straightforward: my vulnerabilities do not erase my rights, my sexuality does not diminish my dignity, and my testimony deserves examination rather than automatic acceptance or dismissal.

This is not a court judgment. It is a personal testimony supported by a documentary preservation effort and a demand for answers. I invite readers to follow the records, test the claims, identify what remains unresolved, and reach conclusions proportionate to the evidence.

The archive remains. The questions remain. And I remain.

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PROLOGUE — I REFUSE TO DISAPPEAR

I have spent years trying to make sense of a life in which I have experienced exclusion, humiliation, financial insecurity, the breakdown of family relationships, institutional rejection, and the repeated denial of the protection and assistance I believed I needed.

I have watched relationships fracture. I have questioned decisions that affected my independence. I have struggled to understand why people who had the capacity to help me appeared, from my perspective, to leave me increasingly isolated. I have sought answers from institutions and preserved records because I refuse to accept that the passage of time should make unanswered questions disappear.

I am Dr Richard William McLean. I completed my PhD at Victoria University in 2020. I have a background in journalism, illustration, and advocacy. I have experienced serious mental-health difficulties, but I refuse to accept that those experiences cancel my right to describe my life, question decisions, preserve evidence, or demand accountability.

My vulnerabilities do not make me disposable. My psychiatric history does not erase my testimony. My sexuality does not diminish my humanity. My poverty does not extinguish my rights.

I have assembled the Barran Dodger archive because I want the documentary record preserved and accessible. It contains material that I believe is important to understanding my experiences and the conduct of the institutions with which I have dealt. Its contents must be assessed document by document, with dates, authorship, context, and the distinction between established facts and disputed interpretations kept clear.

My archive is not a substitute for examining the evidence. It is an invitation to do so.

The central question running through this testimony is this:

How can a person be surrounded by family, community institutions, professionals, and public agencies, yet experience himself as progressively more isolated, less protected, and less able to secure an effective answer when he asks for help?

I have my account of how that happened. I have records I want examined. I have

questions that remain unanswered.

I will not make myself invisible to make other people comfortable.

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I. MY FATHER'S COMMUNITY STANDING — AND MY EXCLUSION FROM HIS WORLD

My father was involved in the local baseball club. As I experienced it, the club was a close-knit, all-male social environment in which the men knew one another and maintained relationships across the town.

Through that involvement, my father was connected to a community network that extended beyond baseball. He knew people in local business and was familiar with people in positions of authority, including people associated with the police and legal profession. He was a recognised member of the community.

I am not suggesting that membership of a baseball club establishes wrongdoing, that every person connected to it shared the same views, or that knowing police officers or lawyers proves anyone acted improperly. That is not the point.

The point is the contrast between my father's social belonging and my experience of exclusion.

I never played baseball. My father did not invite me into that world. From a very early age, I experienced myself as excluded from a significant part of his community life.

He belonged. I was outside.

He had social connections. I did not experience those connections as a source of protection or inclusion for me.

He was known in the town. I later found myself struggling to have my own account of events taken seriously.

That contrast matters because public reputation and private family conduct are different questions. A person can be respected in the community while their child experiences neglect, rejection, or humiliation at home. Neither proposition automatically proves the other, and neither should be used to silence scrutiny.

A community network can provide belonging, familiarity, and mutual support. It can also

create an imbalance when one person is well established within that network and another feels excluded from it. The proper question is whether the network affected how particular events were handled — and that question must be answered through evidence, not assumptions.

I want the chronology of my experiences examined alongside any relevant records and communications. I want specific decisions and actions considered on their merits.

My father's standing in the community cannot, by itself, settle the truth about my life.

The irony I have lived is that I felt excluded from the community world in which my father belonged, yet later found myself trying to explain painful experiences involving sexuality, humiliation, and authority from a position in which I did not feel equally heard or protected.

That is the imbalance I want understood.

II. THE POLICE-STATION INCIDENT — SEXUALITY, HUMILIATION, AND MY QUESTIONS ABOUT A REPORT

I have a deeply troubling account of an incident involving a girl and a local police station. I have come to believe that the circumstances surrounding my first sexual experience were contrived and that a report was created or used to shame me about my sexuality.

I experienced the incident as humiliating. I later came to believe that the girl involved had been fabricated or positioned in circumstances intended to create a report that could be used to gay-shame me.

I stand by my account of my experience and by my demand that the circumstances be examined.

I want the underlying questions answered:

- **Was a police report made?**
- **What does the report actually say?**
- **Who supplied the information?**
- **Who recorded or handled it?**
- **What was the chronology?**
- **Were statements, records, or other evidence retained?**
- **Is there independent evidence supporting or contradicting my understanding of the incident?**
- **Did anyone subsequently repeat information from that incident, and, if so, what**

was the source?

I have also questioned what members of my family knew about the incident and whether information travelled through local social networks. My family was homophobic, as I experienced it, and I believe that this context is important to understanding how my sexuality was treated.

I cannot establish the knowledge or intentions of particular people merely because they knew one another. But neither should those questions be dismissed without examining the actual communications and records that may exist.

I want evidence, not convenient assumptions.

When I came out as gay, I experienced the shaming as intensifying rather than ending. I felt that my sexuality became another means through which I could be degraded, dismissed, or treated as less deserving of dignity.

Let this be unequivocal:

Being gay is not a defect. It is not a crime. It is not a justification for humiliation, discrimination, or the withdrawal of protection.

If anyone used my sexuality to discredit me, that conduct should be examined. If damaging statements were made about me, I want to know who made them, what they said, when they said them, and what evidence supports the account.

I will not accept the proposition that the shame belongs to me because I was the person subjected to it.

If prejudice or deliberate humiliation occurred, responsibility belongs with those who engaged in it.

III. WHEN I CAME OUT — AND THE DOUBLE STANDARD I EXPERIENCED

I have struggled with a contradiction in my family's treatment of me.

I experienced homophobic shame and rejection, yet my former fiancé, Steve Iasonidis, was accepted into the family environment. From my perspective, that acceptance did not translate into meaningful protection for me when I later experienced the relationship as exploitative and harmful.

I have believed that my family aligned itself with Steve Iasonidis and with his treatment of me, including after the relationship ended. I experienced that alignment as a profound betrayal.

The contradiction, as I lived it, was this: my identity as a gay man could be a source of shame, while the man who became my fiancé could be accepted despite the serious concerns I later raised about how I was treated.

I have asked myself why I was the person who continued to experience exclusion while he retained acceptance.

I cannot establish every person's private motive from the outcome alone. But I can ask specific questions about conduct.

Who communicated with Steve Iasonidis about me? What did they know? What did they witness? What did they say when I sought help? Did anyone independently examine my concerns? Were decisions made on the basis of evidence, loyalty, prejudice, or assumptions?

If my family believed that Steve was treating me properly, what was that belief based upon?

If they knew that I was distressed, what did they do?

If they had information that could have helped clarify events, did they share it?

If they supported him while dismissing my account, why?

These questions matter because the consequences were not theoretical. They affected my relationships, my sense of belonging, my ability to obtain support, and my understanding of whether the people closest to me would stand beside me when I was struggling.

A family's integrity is tested not only by whom it welcomes, but by what it does when a vulnerable family member says that something is wrong.

I want the history of my relationship with Steve Iasonidis and the subsequent family interactions examined through a clear chronology of communications, events, and decisions.

I do not want my account dismissed merely because it is painful, nor do I want

conclusions about anyone's motives substituted for evidence. I want the conduct examined, the records preserved, and the unanswered questions addressed.

IV. NANA — THE WOMAN I LOVED, AND THE EXILE I BELIEVE SHE EXPERIENCED

Nana was dearly loved by me. I felt that she had my back. She represented connection, love, and support in a life in which I often felt isolated.

I also came to believe that Nana was separated from important relationships and placed in circumstances in which her independence, choices, and contact with family and friends were restricted.

I experienced this as another form of exile: a person removed from the relationships and familiar world that mattered to her, with her agency diminished and her opportunities for companionship reduced.

I am concerned about whether Nana received the care and protection she needed. I have questioned whether elder abuse, neglect, or inappropriate restriction of her relationships occurred.

Those are serious concerns. They require examination of the available evidence: her living arrangements, care, wishes, financial affairs, contact with family and friends, decision-making arrangements, and the circumstances surrounding her death.

I cannot establish elder abuse merely by describing my suspicions. But the possibility should not be dismissed simply because it concerns a family member or because the people involved may have been regarded as respectable.

What were Nana's wishes?

Who made decisions about her care and living arrangements?

What contact was permitted, and what contact did she want?

Were her choices and relationships respected?

What records exist concerning her health, welfare, finances, and estate?

What happened in the period leading up to her death?

I want those questions answered.

I experienced Nana's death as a devastating loss. I believe she died without the care, companionship, and connection she deserved. I continue to feel spiritually connected to her and experience her presence as a source of comfort and solidarity. That is part of my faith and my personal understanding of our bond.

My spiritual experience is not offered as a substitute for documentary evidence. It is part of my testimony about the meaning Nana continues to hold in my life.

What I cannot ignore is the pattern I have perceived across two generations: Nana, whom I believed had been isolated from relationships and choices that mattered to her, and me, who experienced exclusion from the family and community relationships in which I needed support.

When a person believes that the same family history contains repeated experiences of isolation and loss of agency, the humane response is to examine the questions carefully — neither declaring guilt in advance nor shutting the questions down.

I loved Nana. I believe her life and death deserve to be treated with dignity, and I want the available evidence examined in that spirit.

V. THE $1,000 — THE INHERITANCE QUESTION THAT REMAINS

After Nana died, while I was with Steve Iasonidis, I say that my mother and father took $1,000 from me as compensation connected with the inheritance Nana had left.

I believed, and have continued to wonder, whether I was named in Nana's will or otherwise entitled to an inheritance. I want the actual will, any probate or estate-administration records, relevant correspondence, and the circumstances of the $1,000 payment examined.

I am not claiming that my belief about the will proves that I was legally entitled to a particular amount. The documents must establish what the estate provided for, whether I had any entitlement, and what the payment was intended to settle.

But the questions are legitimate.

Who proposed the payment?

What was it supposed to compensate for?

Was there a written agreement?

Was the will available to me?

Was I informed of the relevant estate arrangements?

Did I receive independent advice?

What records remain?

I remember this event as part of a much wider experience of being financially disadvantaged and excluded. I want the documentary record to establish what happened, rather than allowing an unresolved family recollection to become the final word.

If the records show that I was deprived of money or rights to which I was entitled, that should be acknowledged and addressed.

If they show something different, the documents should establish that too.

The answer to an inheritance question is in the estate records, not in the social standing of the people who controlled the conversation.

VI. THE EUROPEAN HOLIDAY — EVERYONE INCLUDED EXCEPT ME

After these events, members of my family — including Brad, Kira McLean, Jodie and Dave Bongetti, Doug and April McLean, and others — went on an approximately eight-week holiday in Europe together, as I remember it.

I was not included.

I experienced the contrast as devastating. Other family members shared an extended holiday and a collective family experience while I remained outside the circle.

I felt like the scapegoat: the person whose absence did not interrupt the family's ability to continue together, the person who could be left behind while everyone else belonged.

The holiday itself does not prove wrongdoing or establish that it was connected to any inheritance or financial arrangement. I will not pretend that a connection exists without evidence. But its place in the chronology matters to my account of family exclusion.

If financial insecurity, conflict, bereavement, or the absence of support was already affecting me, the contrast between the family travelling together and my own circumstances deepened my sense of abandonment.

I want any relevant financial arrangements, communications, and dates examined where they bear on specific questions. I do not want assumptions substituted for records.

A photograph can show who went on holiday. It cannot, by itself, explain the relationships behind the photograph or establish why someone was excluded.

My point is that I experienced myself as the family member left outside while everyone else continued to belong.

That experience deserves to be heard. The evidence should establish whether there are further facts that explain it.

VII. THE CARER'S PENSION — WHO RECEIVED SUPPORT, AND WHO WAS LEFT STRUGGLING?

I have raised serious questions about carer-related payments and the financial circumstances of people who were involved in my life.

My account is that my parents continued claiming a carer-related payment for years after I had left their accommodation. I have also described Steve Iasonidis as earning approximately $40,000 per month and later seeking a carer-related payment because I was living with him, while I was surviving on approximately $300 per week.

I have said that Steve told me he had discovered information through ASIO and personal data indicating that my parents had been claiming payments for years. I do not have independent confirmation here of any ASIO access, the source of that information, the precise payment history, or whether any claim was unlawful.

The proper response is to investigate the facts.

What payment was involved?

Who received it?

What dates did the payments cover?

What care was said to be provided, and by whom?

What were the applicable eligibility and reporting requirements?

When did my living arrangements change?

What notifications, applications, reviews, or reassessments occurred?

Were there official findings about eligibility or compliance?

What evidence supports the information Steve said he obtained, and how was it obtained?

These questions are capable of documentary examination. They should be addressed through payment records, applications, correspondence, and official decisions, not through speculation about income or personal relationships.

If anyone received public money on the basis of circumstances that did not meet the applicable requirements, that deserves proper examination. If the claims were lawful, the records should establish that.

What makes this issue particularly painful is the possibility that other people may have received financial recognition for caring responsibilities while I remained poor, dependent, and without the support I needed.

I experienced my vulnerability as something that did not result in adequate assistance for me, even while questions arose about whether others were receiving financial benefits connected to my circumstances.

I want the records examined because the public purpose of a caring payment is to support eligible caring arrangements, not to create an unexplained financial advantage for someone at the expense of the person who needs care.

That principle must be applied fairly to everyone.

VIII. THE CONTRADICTION — BEING DIMINISHED WHILE DOING THE WORK

I have experienced being labelled, dismissed, or reduced to a diagnosis when trying to explain my circumstances.

Yet I completed a PhD at Victoria University in 2020. I have a background in journalism

and illustration, and I have spent years engaging with mental health, carers' issues, minority rights, ethics, technology, and institutional accountability.

My education does not make every conclusion I reach automatically correct. A qualification is not proof of a disputed event.

But neither does a psychiatric history automatically disprove my testimony.

My qualifications do not make me infallible. My vulnerabilities do not make me disposable.

I reject the false choice between being treated as an unquestionable authority and being treated as someone whose words can be dismissed without examination.

I am a human being who can describe what I experienced, identify relevant records, ask questions, correct mistakes, and demand that evidence be considered on its merits.

I have invested enormous effort in preserving documents because I do not want my life reduced to competing recollections with no material available for comparison.

The Barran Dodger archive is part of that effort. It is a public documentary resource and a finding aid. It is not a court judgment, and a blockchain timestamp or file hash does not independently prove every assertion in a document.

Those technical features can help establish the preservation and provenance of particular files. The contents must still be read, compared, and assessed in context.

That is precisely why I have preserved them.

IX. THE VOICES, THE THREATS, AND MY DEMAND FOR SAFETY

I need to record something deeply distressing that I experience in my home.

I hear or experience voices that repeat degrading and threatening phrases, including:

- **"You're a rapist."**
- **"You're a pedo."**
- **"You're a faggot."**
- **"No one believes you."**
- **"No one will help."**
- **"Kill yourself."**

These words are frightening, humiliating, and profoundly harmful to experience. They attack my character, my sexuality, my credibility, and my sense that anyone will help me.

I have wondered whether these experiences reflect deliberate harassment or another cause. I have felt that some of the phrases echo language associated with the wider conflicts in my life.

I cannot establish the source of these experiences from the repetition or familiarity of the words alone. I cannot identify a particular police officer, police force, family member, or other person as their source without independent evidence.

But I can state the impact plainly: I experience these words as threatening and degrading, and I want to be safe in my own home.

I refuse to accept that my distress should be used to silence every other question I raise. Equally, I do not want an unverified explanation to be treated as a proven fact. I want the experiences taken seriously, my immediate safety respected, and any objectively verifiable evidence of harassment or threats examined.

The content of the words matters because it targets the most vulnerable points in my life: accusations of sexual wrongdoing, homophobic abuse, the conviction that nobody will believe me, and commands to end my life.

Whatever their source, those experiences deserve a response centred on safety, dignity, and care — not mockery, humiliation, or automatic dismissal.

If there is evidence of an actual threat or harassment, it should be preserved and examined. If the source remains unknown, that uncertainty should be acknowledged honestly.

I am not asking anyone to accept a conclusion without evidence. I am asking that the distress itself not be ignored.

If I feel at immediate risk of acting on the command to kill myself, or unable to keep myself safe, I need urgent human support. My life matters, regardless of the source of the words or the outcome of any investigation.

X. THE FAMILY, THE COMMUNITY, AND THE QUESTION OF WHO WAS BELIEVED

The experiences I have described are connected in my understanding of my life:

exclusion from my father's community world; humiliation and shame associated with my sexuality; conflict involving my former fiancé, Steve Iasonidis; questions about Nana's isolation and care; the unresolved inheritance payment; the European holiday from which I was excluded; and concerns about carer-related payments.

I understand why people may wish to consider each event separately. That is necessary when establishing what the evidence proves.

But separating events for analysis should not mean ignoring their cumulative effect on a human being.

Each unresolved question has existed within a wider experience of loss, insecurity, and diminished belonging. Each time I have felt excluded or disbelieved, it has added to the difficulty of trusting that anyone will examine the next concern fairly.

I cannot establish a coordinated conspiracy merely by placing painful events next to one another. But I can insist that the individual events be examined and that their chronology and cumulative consequences be understood.

I want people to distinguish between three things:

1. **What I directly experienced and remember.**
2. **What documents, independent witnesses, or other evidence can establish.**
3. **What I infer about the reasons behind the events.**

Those categories are not interchangeable. They are the structure of an honest investigation.

My testimony belongs in the record. The evidence should be examined. The conclusions should follow from the material, not from prejudice, loyalty, social familiarity, or assumptions about my mental health.

XI. ADMINISTRATIVE ERASURE — WHEN SEEKING HELP BECOMES ANOTHER STRUGGLE

My concerns do not end with my family.

I have documented years of interactions with public agencies and institutions concerning my rights, employment status, complaints, information requests, financial circumstances, and access to assistance.

Among the matters I have identified are correspondence and records concerning the

Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet, the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner, the Attorney-General's Department, Comcare, WorkSafe, the NDIS Commission, the Commonwealth Ombudsman, the Australian Human Rights Commission, and other bodies.

I have recorded issues concerning FOI requests, information that was said not to exist and was later released, communications that I understood had not been forwarded, employment-status questions, complaint handling, and restrictions on avenues of review.

Each matter must be assessed according to its own documents, applicable law, chronology, and outcome. A refusal or administrative error does not automatically establish corruption or deliberate persecution. But neither does an agency's decision become unquestionable merely because the agency made it.

I want the reasons, records, decision-making processes, and review pathways examined.

Where a document was withheld, I want the legal basis identified.

Where an explanation changed, I want the chronology clarified.

Where an email was not forwarded, I want the consequences examined.

Where an agency declined responsibility, I want the jurisdictional reasoning made clear.

Where a complaint was restricted, I want the decision and its legal basis identified.

Administrative process is supposed to provide a means of resolving disputes and protecting rights. It should not become an endless maze in which the person seeking an answer is progressively exhausted, impoverished, and excluded.

That is the issue I have tried to document through the Barran Dodger archive.

My archive should be read as a finding aid to the records, not as a substitute for reading them. Its significance lies in making material easier to locate, compare, preserve, and scrutinise.

XII. THE EVIDENCE MAP — FOLLOW THE RECORD

The following links provide starting points for examining my documentary record. They

are entry points into the archive, not a claim that every linked page independently proves every statement in this testimony.

1. Main Barran Dodger repository

https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

The main repository provides access to the project's source material and associated records. Individual documents should be assessed for authenticity, completeness, relevance, and context.

2. Official Government Documents Register

https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/official-government-documents-register.html

This register is a starting point for locating government-document material relevant to the issues I have raised.

3. PDF archive

https://github.com/wezzo72/pdf-archive

The PDF repository provides another entry point for preserved documents. A file's presence in the archive does not, by itself, establish the truth of every statement within it.

4. Rebuilt public archive

https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/

This is the rebuilt public archive based on a preservation copy of the website. It is intended to help readers navigate the material.

5. Rebuild repository

https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild

This repository provides access to the rebuild project and its source.

6. Documentary Trap

https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/#documentary-trap-final

This is a designated entry point in the original archive for the material labelled "Documentary Trap." Readers should examine the underlying documents and their context.

7. Victim Impact Statement

https://www.barrandodger.com.au/post/victim-impact-statement

This statement provides another point of reference for my account of the consequences I have experienced.

What the evidence map must establish

For each significant event, the record should identify:

- **The date and location.**
- **The people or agencies directly involved.**
- **The primary document or independent evidence.**
- **What the document establishes and what it does not establish.**
- **Any conflicting evidence or alternative explanation.**
- **The response given by the relevant person or institution.**
- **The practical consequence for me.**
- **What remains unresolved and what further evidence would resolve it.**

For the family-related matters, that may mean wills, estate-administration records, payment records, correspondence, contemporaneous messages, and independent witness accounts.

For the police-station incident, that may mean any report, contemporaneous records, relevant statements, and the chronology of the incident.

For the carer-payment questions, that may mean the exact payment type, relevant dates, eligibility requirements, applications, notifications, and official decisions.

For my institutional complaints, that means the original correspondence, decisions, reasons, review records, and relevant legal provisions.

This is how the record can become more than a collection of claims: by allowing every significant proposition to be traced to the material that supports or contradicts it.

XIII. THE MORAL QUESTION — WHO PROTECTED WHOM?

The moral question at the heart of my testimony is not complicated.

When I was a child, did I receive the inclusion, care, and protection I needed?

When I experienced humiliation about my sexuality, was I treated with dignity?

When I raised concerns about my relationship with Steve Iasonidis, were those concerns taken seriously and examined fairly?

When Nana's circumstances raised concerns for me, were her wishes, care, independence, and relationships properly protected?

When questions arose about inheritance and carer-related payments, were the financial facts made clear?

When I sought answers from institutions, were the decisions explained, the records preserved, and the appropriate review mechanisms available?

Those are questions about conduct and consequences. They do not require anyone to prejudge the answer.

I do not ask for immunity from scrutiny. I ask for scrutiny to be applied consistently — to me, to my family, to former partners, to public officials, and to institutions.

I want the evidence to be strong enough to withstand examination. I want errors corrected. I want disputed interpretations identified as disputed. And where the records establish wrongdoing, I want it acknowledged rather than concealed behind reputation or procedure.

No person's social standing should make their conduct immune from examination. No person's vulnerability should make their testimony unworthy of examination.

Those principles must operate together.

XIV. THE WITNESS REMAINS

I have been left with questions that reach across family, community, relationships, money, sexuality, institutions, and the meaning of protection.

I have described feeling excluded from my father's world, humiliated because I was gay, unsupported in a relationship I experienced as harmful, distressed by Nana's circumstances, uncertain about an inheritance payment, and troubled by questions concerning carer-related payments.

I have also described experiences of threatening voices and degrading language that have made me feel unsafe and disbelieved.

These experiences are part of my testimony. The precise causes, motives, and responsibilities must be established through the relevant evidence. I will not pretend that every unresolved question has already been answered.

But I will not accept that uncertainty is a licence to disregard the person asking the questions.

I have preserved my records because I believe the truth deserves a durable place outside the shifting memories, loyalties, and explanations of individual people.

I have built the Barran Dodger archive because documents matter. Dates matter. The original wording matters. Context matters. A record that can be examined is more useful than a conclusion that demands unquestioning acceptance.

And the human being behind the record matters.

I am not merely a diagnosis.

I am not merely a family dispute.

I am not merely a former fiancé's version of events.

I am not merely a file number, a complaint reference, a payment record, or a collection of administrative decisions.

I am a person who has lived through these experiences and who continues to seek answers.

I will not pretend to know what the evidence has not yet established. But I will not surrender the right to ask what happened, who knew, what decisions were made, what consequences followed, and whether those decisions were fair.

I want the evidence read. I want the chronology reconstructed. I want the unanswered

questions addressed. I want the consequences for my life understood. And where the record establishes wrongdoing, I want meaningful accountability.

The truth does not become less worthy of examination because the person demanding it has been isolated.

A person's suffering does not become irrelevant because the people around them have reputations to protect.

A gay man's dignity is not conditional on his family's approval.

An elderly woman's independence is not a matter to be dismissed when someone raises concerns about her care.

A financial question deserves a documentary answer.

An administrative decision deserves reasons that can be examined.

And a human being who asks for help deserves to be treated as a human being.

I am Richard William McLean. I am the author of my own testimony. I remain responsible for what I say, and I remain entitled to have my evidence examined.

The archive remains.

The questions remain.

And I remain.

STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANCE

The Barran Dodger archive is a public documentary preservation project intended to make a substantial body of material easier to locate, preserve, and scrutinise. Its significance is not that every interpretation within it should be accepted without question. Its significance is that records can be examined, chronologies reconstructed, inconsistencies identified, and unanswered questions pursued without relying exclusively on any one person's recollection or authority.

This testimony places personal experience alongside a demand for documentary

accountability. It distinguishes memory, evidence, and inference while refusing to treat the author's vulnerability as grounds for automatic dismissal. It asks that family relationships, community standing, sexuality, financial arrangements, care, and institutional decisions be examined according to the same basic principles: evidence, fairness, dignity, and accountability.

Not a court. Not a verdict. A record to be examined, a life to be heard, and questions that deserve answers.